

TRIANGLE

Trikonasana

Triangle is a strengthening and grounding standing pose. It involves twisting your spine and ribcage to move against gravity and the tendency to round forward and down. Strong poses like this can strengthen both your muscles and bones.

THE BIG PICTURE

This pose particularly strengthens your core, thighs, and legs. Deep muscles close to your spine engage to stabilize your spine and give your brain feedback, enhancing your mind-body connection.

Neck and torso

To rotate your neck, on the side nearer the ground (model's left), your **sternocleidomastoid, rotatores, multifidus**, and **semispinalis cervicis** engage, while stretching on the upward-facing side (model's right). On the upward side, your **splenius capitis** and **splenius cervicis** engage, while stretching on the downward side. Your **transversus abdominis** engages to stabilize your spine. On the upward-facing side, your **external obliques** stretch, while your **internal obliques** engage to rotate your spine. On the downward side, your **external obliques** engage to rotate your spine.

Sternocleidomastoid
Spinal extensors
Spine
Abdominal obliques
Transversus abdominis

Arms
Your shoulders are abducted by your **middle deltoids** and **supraspinatus** and stabilized by your **rotator cuff muscles**. Your **posterior deltoids** externally rotate your shoulders. Your elbows are extended by your **triceps** and forearms turned palms forward by your **supinators**.

Supinator
Elbow
Brachialis
Triceps brachii
Deltoids
Pectoralis minor
Supraspinatus

Arm reaches up

Bring shoulder blade back

Back hip rotating inward

Front hip rotating outward

Knees soft, not locked

Center of gravity
Press into outer edge of foot

ALIGNMENT

Rotate your back hip inward by turning your toes inward. Rotate your front hip outward by turning your toes toward the front of your mat. Rotate your spine to stack your shoulder blades vertically.

